

Figure 4.14 *Chisht, mausoleums (or madrasa/mosque complex), ruins: Mausoleum A, interior, inscription, detail. Powell: "Detail of [inscription] which has been read to me, 'In the days of the kingdom of Al Mozafar Almansour … '"**
*Cf. Appendix II, Afghanistan III:4, below, for an updated reading of this inscription.

within the large corner arches contain the names of the first four *khalifa*s, the Prophets, *Shahada*, and doxologies. The smaller, paired-arch motifs in between contain doxologies.[75]

Although only a small portion of the Chisht complex's epigraphic program survives – not dissimilar to Shah-i Mashhad – it is noteworthy that the available inscriptions as well as the complex's formal characteristics point toward a funerary function for the site, probably serving other purposes as well. The domed chamber layout of the northeastern structure, discussed above, strongly suggests that it was a tomb with a *mihrab* – a not uncommon architectural typology in the eastern Islamic lands by the later twelfth century.[76] Additionally, the western domed structure, while apparently not having a *mihrab*, provides ample epigraphic indications of a funerary association through its interior inscriptions. The cursive inscription beginning in the southeastern corner with the anachronistic mention